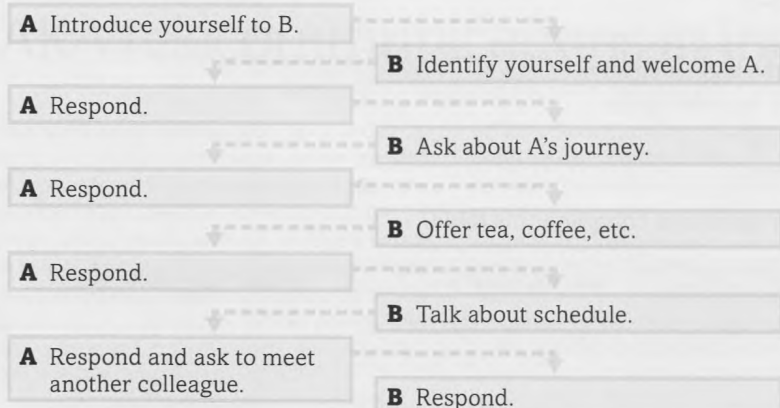


- 5 Work with a partner. Have a conversation with a visitor to your place of work using this flow chart. Student A is the visitor and Student B is the host. When you have finished, change roles.



- 6 Work with a partner. Imagine you are welcoming a new person to the class today. Have a short conversation about their journey to the office / classroom and go through the schedule for the lesson.
- 7 28► It is the start of the tour. Listen to this welcome speech and answer questions 1–3.
- Who is Dilip Patel?
 - How is the day organized?
 - What piece of advice does Dilip give the visitors?
- 8 28► Dilip's speech is more formal than Jacinta's conversation with Marvin. Listen again and find formal equivalents to these phrases.
- Welcome to ...: _____
 - You'll get a chance to ...: _____
 - Remember ...: _____
 - Make sure you ...: _____

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 6 on page 112.

- 9 Work in small groups. Prepare and give a short welcome speech to a group of first-time visitors to your place of work or study.

» Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Welcoming

Welcome to ...
It's nice to meet you in person.
Likewise.
Good morning. / Good afternoon.
On behalf of ...
It gives me great pleasure to welcome you to ...

Asking about a journey

How was your journey?
Did you have any trouble finding us?

Being hospitable

Can I get you a coffee?
Let me take your coat.
Have a seat.

Explaining the programme

Let me run through / go over today's programme.
First of all, I thought you could ...
We'll catch up again later / at ...
You will have the opportunity to ...
You'll get a chance to ...
We're going to begin with ...

Giving extra information

Make sure you ...
Please be sure to ...
Don't worry about (+ noun / -ing) ...
Can I remind you that ...
For your own safety, ...

Ending

Before I hand over to ...
May I wish you all an enjoyable visit.

» Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to make and respond to offers

- 1 Which of these offers are more / less formal?
- | | |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1 Would you like a drink? | 3 Do you fancy a drink? |
| 2 Do you want a drink? | 4 Can I get you a drink? |
- 2 29► Complete these responses to the offers in 1 with words from the list. Then listen to six conversations and check your answers.
- would sounds fine time love please
- | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1 No thanks, I'm _____. | 4 A drink _____ good. |
| 2 That _____ be great, thanks. | 5 I'd _____ one. |
| 3 Yes, _____. A coffee would be nice. | 6 I'm afraid I don't have _____. |
- 3 One of you is the host and the other is the guest. Decide if the guest is: your boss, a colleague, a visitor you haven't met before, or a regular visitor to your company. Offer your guest these things then change roles.
- dinner this evening
 - a quick tour of the plant
 - lunch in the canteen

Tip | catch up

Catch up has several meanings. Used with *with*, *catch up* means see someone again.

We'll **catch up** (with each other) later.

Used with *on*, *catch up* means to get back on schedule with work.

I'm working late this evening as I have a lot of work **to catch up on**.

Language at work | Obligation, necessity, and prohibition

1 30▷ Aruna Singh is showing visitors around her company. Listen and answer questions 1–3.

- 1 What happens in the clean room?
- 2 What is the biggest enemy?
- 3 What are the rules about
 - a clothing?
 - b jewellery?

2 30▷ Listen again and complete this table.

necessary	not necessary	against the rules
room is dust-free		

3 Put sentences and questions a–h below into categories 1–6.

- 1 Talking about a prohibition: _____
 - 2 Talking about necessities / obligations: _____
 - 3 Talking about an absence of obligation or necessity: _____
 - 4 Asking if there is a prohibition: _____
 - 5 Asking if something is necessary: _____
 - 6 Talking about a rule that is not very strict: _____
- a Everyone **has to** wear a special overall.
 - b **Do we have to** get undressed?
 - c No, you **don't need to** worry.
 - d You **don't have to** undress.
 - e You **mustn't** wear any natural fibres.
 - f You're **not supposed to** wear jewellery.
 - g We **need to** follow a very strict procedure.
 - h **Are we allowed to** go inside?

»» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 6 on page 113.

4 Work with a partner. Finish these sentences so that they are true for you.

- In my organization we have to ...
- Luckily, we don't have to ...
- At work we're not supposed to ...
- Where I work no one is allowed to ...
- If you work here, you mustn't ...

5 Work with a partner. One of you is welcoming a new colleague to your place of work. Tell him / her about the rules you have to follow. The other should ask questions about the rules. Talk about

- taking breaks
- phone and Internet for private use
- identification and security
- health and safety
- what to do about receiving guests on site
- car parking
- leaving PCs on overnight
- any other rules you can think of.

Tip | Softening rules and regulations

Use *supposed to* to talk about a rule which is often broken, or to make the rule you give sound 'softer'.

*We're not **supposed to** eat or drink in the computer room, but often we're so busy that we have a sandwich while we're working.*

① » Interactive Workbook » Exercises and Tests

Solving an intercultural problem

Background

AKA telecommunications in India

AKA is a Swedish software technology and design company. They create products and services for the computer and telecommunications industries. Six months ago they started work on a major project with an Indian software developer based in Bangalore. A number of project managers from Sweden, some of them women, relocated to India to manage the different parts of the project. They are working with local managers, and software designers and engineers.

Since the Swedish managers arrived, things have not gone as well as AKA hoped. The standard of work is very high, but the project is

behind schedule, and several important delivery dates have been missed. Also, the relationship between the Swedish managers and their Indian teams is getting worse. Meetings to review progress and make decisions are often very long, and the outcome is not always clear. There have also been some communication problems, even though everyone speaks 'good' English.

The Swedes now see their Indian colleagues as disorganized, inefficient and unwilling to take responsibility. The Indians think the Swedes are too informal and relaxed at work, don't say what they want, and are unable to make decisions.

Discussion

- 1 Make a list of the main problems. What are possible reasons for these problems?
- 2 How could management improve the situation?
- 3 If you were relocated to a different country to work on a joint venture, how would you prepare yourself?
- 4 Imagine someone from a different cultural background comes to work for your company for a year. How would you explain your work culture? Think about: dress code, hierarchy and status, attitudes towards time and deadlines, the working day, attitudes towards meetings and communications at work, etiquette / politeness (e.g. using first or last names).

Task

You and your partner work for two companies involved in a joint venture in the same situation as AKA and their Indian partner. Student A, you are the Human Resources Director of the Swedish company and Student B, you are the Human Resources Director of the Indian company. Try to find out the reasons for the problems with the joint project and work together to make some recommendations as to how the situation could be improved.

- 1 You have each received a number of complaints from your own employees about the current situation. Have a meeting to find out why things are going wrong. Student A, turn to File 10 on page 137. Student B, turn to File 17 on page 139. Make a list of the issues to resolve.
- 2 Work with your partner and discuss how to deal with each issue in 1.
Example: We could ask the Swedish managers to send a memo out saying they would appreciate punctuality at meetings. / We could advise Swedish managers to get someone to call them once everyone has gathered for a meeting.
- 3 Work together. Look at the suggestions in File 15 on page 138. Discuss the pros and cons of each suggestion then choose one to recommend to the management of the joint venture (Swedish and Indian). Present your choice, giving reasons, to another group.

The Expert View

National culture is patterns of behaviour and attitudes that are learned and shared among a group. Problems between people from different cultures can occur because of their different responses to particular situations. For example, some cultures value personal relationships more than the rule of the law; others believe regulations must be obeyed, independent of friends or family. To deal with intercultural problems you need to understand your own culture, be sensitive to other people's behaviour and attitudes, and be interested in other people's viewpoints.

Dr Michael Dickmann, Senior Lecturer,
Director MSc International HRM
Cranfield School of Management

Case study



7 Security

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about security in the workplace
- Explaining and asking about changes
- Introducing and responding to news
- Using the present perfect and connectors to talk about change and consequences

Case study

- Improving data security

Starting point

- 1 What security measures can / do you use to protect your home and possessions?
- 2 Which of these security measures do you use at work?
- 3 Why is security an important issue for companies?

Working with words | Security at work

1 Read these articles and answer questions 1–3.

- 1 In each article, what was the security breach?
- 2 What was stolen in each case?
- 3 Who were the victims of each theft?

Credit agency reports security breach

More than 1,400 Canadians have been notified of a major security breach at Equifax Canada Inc., a national consumer-credit reporting agency. According to reports, unauthorized access was gained to the personal, detailed credit files which contained social insurance numbers, bank account numbers, home addresses, and job descriptions. With identity theft in Canada rising in one year from 8,100 to 13,000 reported cases, the industry is once again asking how to safeguard databases against identity theft, and deter people from entering the system without passwords.



Burglar doing 'overtime'

Police arrested a man last week for stealing from his company's warehouse. Over a period of three months, the employee used his own security pass to open up the warehouse in the middle of the night and load a van in full view of security cameras. The boxes contained DVDs and CDs. When police questioned security staff who were paid to monitor for such activity, they said, 'We thought he was just doing overtime.' A member of staff finally reported the man when he saw him selling DVDs in a street market on a Saturday afternoon. The company has decided to review its security procedures.



2 Find words in the articles in 1 to put into these categories.

Security measures

password

Security breaches

3 Work with a partner. Discuss questions 1–3.

- 1 Has there ever been a security breach at work? If so, what happened?
- 2 What do you need authorized access for at work?
- 3 Which members of staff are responsible for security? What do they monitor?

4 Find verbs in the articles in 1 to complete these verb + preposition phrases.

1		2		3	
insure	+ against	stop	+ (someone / something) from	check	+ for
protect		prevent		scan	
_____		_____		_____	

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 7 on page 114.

5 Look at these extracts from a credit card company information leaflet. Use a verb + preposition phrase from 4. Then work with a partner and compare your answers.

- 1 You can _____ your card _____ loss for as little as €1 per month.
- 2 To _____ anyone else _____ getting your card by mistake, all cards are sent recorded delivery.
- 3 _____ the envelope _____ any signs that it might have been opened before you accept the delivery.
- 4 To _____ anyone else _____ using your card, make sure you sign it immediately.
- 5 To _____ fraud, never write your PIN (Personal Identification Number) down – keep it in your head.
- 6 Make sure you _____ your monthly bank statement _____ any unauthorized use of your card.

6 Work with a partner. Take turns to choose one of the security measures below and describe what it's for, using a verb + preposition phrase from 4. Your partner must guess what you are talking about.

- PIN number
- password
- burglar alarm
- X-ray machine
- security pass
- CCTV
- lock and key
- antivirus software

Example: A We use it to safeguard against other people taking our money.

B Is it a PIN number?

A Yes.

7 Work with a partner. Think about your answers in the Starting point. Tell your partner why those security measures are in place.

» Interactive Workbook » Glossary

Tip | safety and security

Safety and security have different meanings. *Safety* is when someone / something is not in danger or at risk.

*I am concerned about the **safety** of the lifts in this building.*

Security means the activities involved in protecting a person / country / building, etc.

*We need to introduce new **security** measures to prevent thefts.*

Presenting | Explaining and asking about changes



1 The pictures show some security measures for entering a building. What are the advantages and disadvantages of each?

2 **31▷** Listen to two extracts from a meeting and answer questions 1–2.

- 1 What is the current security system? What is the new system?
- 2 What are the advantage and the disadvantage of the new system?

3 **31▷** Match 1–12 to a–l. Then listen again and check your answers.

- 1 What I want to do today, ... ____
- 2 I'll talk about ... ____
- 3 As you know, we've recently ... ____
- 4 Up to now, ... ____
- 5 Because of this ... ____
- 6 So, first, I'd like to update you ... ____
- 7 As a result, ... ____
- 8 What's the reason for ... ____
- 9 It's because security ... ____
- 10 Can you tell us ... ____
- 11 Do you mean that ... ____
- 12 The current situation, as it stands, ... ____

- a more about them?
- b we've decided to upgrade the system.
- c changing the current system?
- d no one has stolen anything ...
- e been having a few problems ...
- f is to explain ...
- g on the plans for changes to ...
- h the background to the situation ...
- i we have to swipe every time ...?
- j can't always check ...
- k simply doesn't prevent ...
- l we've been installing ...

4 Put the phrases in 3 into these categories.

- Introduce a talk: 1
- Give background information: _____
- Ask for information / clarification / an explanation: _____
- Give an explanation / reason: _____

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 7 on page 114.

5 Work with a partner. Student A, turn to File 08 on page 137. Student B, turn to File 18 on page 139. Make notes on the information in your email. Then take turns to give an update using this flow chart.

A Give background information and describe changes to the security system.

A Give an explanation.

B Ask for an explanation.

B Ask for further clarification / information about how the new system will work.

A Give more details about the new system.

6 Work with a partner or in small groups. Think of a situation at work that changed, either recently or in the past. Explain the original circumstances, what the change was, and the reasons for it. Be prepared to answer any questions or requests for further explanation. It might be

- a new security system
- a reorganization of your working space
- a reorganization of your team structure
- a new pricing system
- a new delivery system
- a change in your way of travelling to work.

» Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Introducing a talk

What I want to do today is ...
I'll talk about ...
I'll run through ...

Giving background information

As you know, we've recently ...
As you are aware ...
Up to now ...
I'd like to update you on ...
The situation / problem now is that ...
We expect the situation to ...
The situation, as it stands ...

Asking for an explanation

What's the reason for ...?
I don't quite understand how it works.
Can you tell us (more) about ...?
What do you mean by ...?

Giving an explanation

It's because of the fact that ...
As a result, ...
Because of this ...
By (+ -ing) ..., we can / hope to ...

Checking information

So, if I understand you correctly ...
Do you mean that ...?
I'm not sure I follow you.

» Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to introduce and respond to news

1 Which of these phrases help to create interest (C)? Which phrases show interest in what the other person is saying (S)?

- You're kidding! ____
- How long have you known about that? ____
- Have you heard the news? ____
- Guess what I've just seen? ____
- I've just heard something really interesting! ____
- I've never heard that before! ____
- What's happened? ____
- Really? ____

2 32▷ Listen to four conversations and check your answers in 1.

3 Think of two pieces of recent news, one true and the other false. Work with a partner. Take turns to tell your news and guess which piece of news is false.

Language at work | Present perfect simple and continuous | Connectors

1 Which of the sentences a–b below is about

- 1 an unfinished action continuing up to now? ____
- 2 a completed action / completed actions in an unfinished time period? ____
- a We've recently **been having** a few problems.
- b We've **had** three incidents reported since the beginning of the month.

2 Which sentence in 1 uses the present perfect simple and which uses the present perfect continuous?

» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 7 on page 115.

3 Choose the correct answer from the verb forms in *italics*.

- 1 We've *worked* / 've *been working* on this current project for five months now.
- 2 They've *completed* / 've *been completing* the proposal and here it is.
- 3 How many times have you *been meeting* / *met* the CEO?
- 4 Sorry, but I don't think I've *understood* / 've *been understanding*.

4 Work with a partner. Take turns to ask and answer questions using the prompts below, starting with *Have you ...?* or *How long ...?* In some cases it may be possible to use either the simple or continuous form.

Example: How long have you been studying English?

Have you ever studied English before?

- | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1 study / English | 5 have / problems at work |
| 2 live / in your current home | 6 have / your car |
| 3 be / current position | 7 use / new mobile phone |
| 4 work / current project | 8 know / your English teacher |

5 Read sentences 1–4. Does the word / phrase in **bold** in each sentence show the reason for an action or the result of an action? Write *reason* or *result*.

- 1 An employee has had her bag stolen from her office desk. **Consequently**, we've decided to install a new PIN number system of security. _____
- 2 **In order that** visitors can be allowed into the building, you have to inform security the day before. _____
- 3 We have to change the current system **because of** the fact that security can't always check everyone's badge. _____
- 4 We need to give everyone a password **in order to** prevent unauthorized access. _____

6 Match these words to the words in **bold** in 5.

so due to therefore so that to as a result

» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 7 on page 115.

7 Work with a partner. Take turns to make sentences or questions about things that have happened or have been happening at work. Use one of the words from the list and a connector from 5 or 6 in each of your sentences. Answer your partner's questions.

recently still ever never for yet since

Example: I've recently been taking very short lunch breaks because of the fact that I have such a heavy workload.

Improving data security

Background

Company faces high costs because of security breach

CastCard Corp. (CCC) processes data for a number of major credit card companies in the United States. The company, based in Arizona, recently announced that information on more than 40 million credit cards may have been stolen.

The security breach happened when an unauthorized person from outside the company was able to enter the CCC network and access cardholder data. It was discovered during a routine check for credit card fraud. Although the person was able to get information on

customers' credit card numbers, the cards themselves do not hold personal information like social security numbers or dates of birth. The information could be used for credit card fraud, but not to steal customers' identities.

CCC is working with the police to investigate the security breach. All the credit card companies have said that CCC will be responsible for any illegal transactions and customers will not lose any money. Security procedures at the company are now being changed.

Discussion

- 1 What could happen to CastCard Corp. as a result of this security breach? Why?
- 2 What can the company do to make its customers feel better about the situation?
- 3 How could CCC change its security measures to stop this happening again?

Task

You work for a financial company. Many of your competitors have experienced security breaches. These have cost them a lot of money and have created bad publicity. Your company wants to safeguard against these problems and is considering some changes to its security measures.

- 1 Read these possible options. Think about the advantages and disadvantages of each option.

Memo | Company security policy

- 1 Check the background of all potential employees before recruiting them.
 - 2 Restrict the number of employees who are allowed to take laptops home.
 - 3 Restrict the number of employees who have access to confidential information.
 - 4 Do not allow employees to use personal USB devices at work.
 - 5 Run training programmes for employees to inform and update them about good security procedures. Also, explain what will happen if they break the rules.
 - 6 Reward loyalty so that fewer people leave the company, taking information with them. For example, paying people bonuses related to how long they have worked for the company.
 - 7 Don't keep any confidential data stored on laptops. Keep all the data at the office and use remote access to view the data when working on laptops outside the office.
 - 8 Use an encryption system (coding system with password access) for data on laptops.
- 2 Work in small groups. Discuss all the options. Decide which are the three most important options for the company.
 - 3 Present your ideas to another group. Be prepared to answer questions about your decisions. Can both groups agree on three options for a company action plan?

The Expert View

To protect their reputations, companies don't commonly publicize the fact that 80% of all fraud is internal. In an attempt to reduce security breaches in today's increasingly regulated and complex global recruitment market, most employers carry out pre-employment screening in the following three areas: CV verification – checking an applicant's experience and qualifications; background screening – checking an applicant is who they say they are, and that they don't have a criminal record; medical checks – ensuring that the applicant is fit and able to do the job.

Eyal Ben Cohen, Managing Director,
Verifile Limited, MBA graduate
Cranfield School of Management

Case study



8 Working together

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about working in teams
- Presenting and discussing plans
- Encouraging people
- Using *will*, *going to*, and modal verbs to talk about your goals

Case study

- Creating a plan for effective teamwork

Starting point

1 Match these eight names to make four partnerships.

John Lennon, Domenico Dolce, Douwe Egberts, Crédit Lyonnais, Philips, Paul McCartney, Tour de France, Stefano Gabbana

2 Which sectors do / did the companies / people work in?

3 What is / was the nature of their partnership?

4 What do you think are possible benefits of teams and partnerships?

Working with words | Teamwork and partnerships

1 What skills and abilities do the people in these pictures need?



2 How important are teamwork and regular meetings where you work?

3 Some companies use psychological tests to check if someone will be a good team player. Do this questionnaire and compare your results with a partner.

	Agree	Disagree
1 Life is easier when someone else tells you what to do.	☐	☐
2 I would rather work on my own than with other people.	☐	☐
3 I prefer to work with people who are different from me.	☐	☐
4 Winning is more important than getting on with other people.	☐	☐
5 I usually welcome suggestions from other people.	☐	☐
6 Colleagues are often more dangerous than business rivals.	☐	☐

- 4 33▷ Harriet and Conrad work in the project management section of a large finance group. They are looking for someone to join their team. They are discussing a candidate's responses to the questionnaire in 3. Listen to their conversation. Which choices did the candidate make?
- 5 33▷ Match the words in A to the words in B to make phrases. Then listen again and check your answers.

A	B
take	skills
team	forces
work	responsibility
join	benefit
complementary	alliances
common	closely
form	venture
joint	goals
mutual	player
shared	ground

- 6 Work with a partner. Match the phrases you made in 5 to definitions 1–10.

- 1 when two people have different abilities that work well together: _____
- 2 come together to form a team: _____
- 3 put yourself in a position to be blamed if something goes wrong: _____
- 4 advantageous to both sides: _____
- 5 make partnerships: _____
- 6 have a strong working relationship with: _____
- 7 project that is being worked on by two or more parties: _____
- 8 similar objectives: _____
- 9 someone who works well in a team: _____
- 10 similar ideas or experience in something: _____

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 8** on page 116.

- 7 Work with a partner. Think of a current or future project one of you is working on. This could be at work or at home. You have to form a team of four, including you and your partner, and two people from the list below, to complete this project.

- 1 Decide which two people would be best in your team. Think about the skills you and they can offer.
- 2 Tell the class why you have chosen these two people.

Greta: Quiet and hard-working. Very methodical. Good at statistical analysis. Good at detail. Quite shy.

Carlos: Friendly. Good team player and very easy to talk to. No special skills, but quite good at everything. Has a lot of experience of dealing with clients.

Billy: Very good communication and presentation skills. Can get angry and aggressive. Has a lot of friends and colleagues in the business. Likes to lead and be dominant.

Penny: Clever with words. Quite creative and artistic. Sometimes lazy, needs others to keep her on track.

Stevie: IT specialist with good financial skills. Not very good with people. Can be difficult.

Tessa: Experienced office manager. Good at logistics and systems. Gets on well with most people. Cool and organized. Not very imaginative or creative.

Tip | rather

Use *would rather* to state a preference between two things.

A Do you want to eat in the canteen or go out?

B I'd rather go out.

Use *rather than* to express a better option.

We should keep to the original teams **rather than** change them.

Meetings | Presenting and discussing plans



- 1 Merging companies or departments can be difficult. Work in small groups and talk about the problems that might happen in the following areas.
 - 1 personal relationships and teamwork
 - 2 working space
 - 3 old and new hierarchies
 - 4 ways of doing things
- 2 34▷ Quoteus Insurance is merging with Buckler Insurance Services. Quoteus managers, Carmen and Nikos, are meeting with Erica and Dieter, their counterparts from Buckler. They are discussing how to overcome feelings of suspicion between staff. Listen and make notes on Erica's notepad.

Nikos's plan:

How it will work:

Timescale of the plan:

What he needs before he can launch it:

- 3 What other way of breaking down barriers do they discuss?
- 4 34▷ Listen again and complete these phrases.
 - 1 We _____ to be ready on schedule.
 - 2 Where does this _____ us?
 - 3 _____ the next few weeks ...
 - 4 ... I _____ to hold a series of small meetings.
 - 5 How long will it _____ to involve all the staff?
 - 6 I _____ to have seven or eight sessions.
 - 7 What's the _____ on this?
 - 8 _____ the end of next month.
 - 9 What's the next _____?
 - 10 It is _____ that ...
 - 11 ... there'll be a few problems in the short _____
 - 12 But the _____ are ...
 - 13 ... there won't be too many personality clashes in the _____ run.

Tip | likely and pretty

These adjectives can mean something different from what you might immediately think. *Likely* can mean *probable*.

Share prices are **likely** to go down after this disaster.

Pretty can mean *reasonably*.

I'm **pretty** sure that won't happen.

5 Put the phrases from 4 into these categories.

- a Talking about a future hope, a plan, or expectations: _____
 b Asking and talking about time needed: _____
 c Asking and talking about an action needed: _____

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 8** on page 116.

6 Work with a partner. Continue the meeting from 2. There are two other important topics on the agenda – organization of office space and creation of the new departmental organigram. Student A, turn to File 19 on page 139. Student B, use the information below. Read your information before you start.**Student B**

You are creating the new departmental organigram (diagram which shows the hierarchy of the department).

This is a very sensitive subject because of the status of different job titles in different companies.

Your plans are to

- conduct individual interviews with key staff
- prepare a draft document for discussion.

By the end of the month: have small working parties

In six weeks' time: have proposal for both Quoteus and Buckler

In two months' time: make decision and inform staff

- 1 Your partner will describe his / her plans for the project he / she is working on.
- 2 Tell your partner what you are working on, how you expect it to go, and describe your plans.

7 Think about the next twelve months at work. Look in your diaries if you want. Make short notes about your immediate plans and your long-term plans. Tell the class.

» Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions**Describing plans and intentions**

We're also going to ...

X is going to ...

Expressing future hopes and expectations

We expect to ...

We hope to ...

I plan to ...

I intend to ...

The chances are ...

It is likely to / that ...

Asking how much time is needed

How long will it take to ...?

What's the timescale on this?

Asking about immediate action

Where does this leave us?

What's the next step?

Time expressions

Over the next few weeks ...

By the end of the / next month ...

By Tuesday ...

In the short / medium / long term ...

In the long run ...

» Interactive Workbook
 » Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to encourage people**1 35▷ Listen to five extracts from conversations. Which of the phrases a–e below show the speaker is**

- 1 very happy about something? _____
 2 not very sure about something? _____

- a Well done!
 b It's a start.
 c Great work, everyone.
 d That's an excellent idea.
 e That has potential.

2 Work in small groups. You have two minutes to do one of the following.

- Come up with an idea to improve something in your workplace.
- Write a new slogan for your company.
- Design a visual diagram of your company's activities and partners.

3 Look at everyone else's creations or listen to their ideas. Take turns to comment on them.

Language at work | Talking about the future – *going to*, *will*, and modal verbs

- 1** Carmen works for Quoteus Insurance. She has written to her colleague, Kirsten, with an update on how plans are going for a merger between their company and another insurance company. Read her email and answer questions 1–2.

- 1 How optimistic is Carmen about the schedule?
- 2 What predictions does she make?

Dear Kirsten,

I just wanted to let you know that Erica is **going to** prepare a list of key people to consult on the new hierarchy and departmental structure. Based on feedback I've received from staff meetings, I can see that this is **going to** be a sensitive issue for some people, but the steps we are taking **should** reduce problems. There **could** be trouble, and I expect that a few people **will** leave.

Anyway, the basic message is that everything is on schedule, so we **should** be in the new premises by the end of June. By the way, it **might** be useful for you to come to the next meeting. We're going to discuss the allocation of work space. There **could** be some issues which affect you directly. I'll keep you posted on any developments in the meantime.

All the best,

Carmen

- 2** Complete sentences 1–6 with the words in bold from the email in 1.

- 1 Use _____ to make a confident prediction.
- 2 Use _____ and _____ when we are less confident but think something is possible.
- 3 Use _____ for predictions which are based on evidence we can see in front of us.
- 4 Use _____ to make a prediction based on what is usual or expected.
- 5 Use _____ for an intention to do something.
- 6 Use _____ for a spontaneous offer, promise, or decision.

- 3** Complete sentences 1–6 with words from 2.

- a There _____ be a train in two minutes; there is usually one at that time.
- b The price of commodities _____ definitely continue to rise.
- c I think I' _____ come in on Saturday – there's just so much to do.
- d This decision _____ cause problems if we don't handle it carefully.
- e What terrible sales figures! We are _____ go bankrupt if things don't improve.
- f He's _____ apply for the manager's job.

» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 8** on page 117.

- 4** Work with a partner. Read situations 1–5 and decide what you would say.

- 1 Your boss is worried about you missing a deadline. Reassure him / her.
- 2 Your colleague usually arrives at work at 9.30. It's 9.15. Somebody asks you where she is.
- 3 With a quarter of the year left, you've only reached half of your sales target.
- 4 Your head of department has just been promoted. Someone asks you if you want to apply for his / her job. You are not sure.
- 5 You sent a document by post to a client. They need it in two days. You are fairly confident that this is OK. They want to know where it is.

- 5** Make notes about your short- and long-term goals in your job and at home. Work with a partner or in small groups. Tell each other what your goals are.

Tip | Adding extra information and changing topic

Use *by the way* and *incidentally* to add extra information or thoughts.

By the way, you should try to come to the next meeting.

Incidentally, Erica is bilingual.

» Interactive Workbook » Exercises and Tests

Creating a plan for effective teamwork

Background

Virtual teamwork at Nortel

Nortel creates Internet technologies, and has 80,000 employees located in 150 countries. It conducts business 24 hours a day, seven days a week with people on different continents and in different time zones.

The HR Director works at the head office in Ontario, Canada, but as a member of a virtual team, she has colleagues as far away as Europe and China. She trained her virtual team of 60 finance and legal employees on deal-making skills. Since they were located throughout the world, she used a group meeting technology

tool called Meeting Manager. Virtual participants were on individual PCs and also on a teleconference line.

The meeting took place in real time from team members' desktops. Charts from the presenters were uploaded onto Meeting Manager, which allowed for group viewing. The chair was able to control the order of the meeting and the viewing of the charts. Participants posted questions on an electronic white board, which could be answered online or by phone.

Discussion

- 1 What is a 'virtual team'? How does the team meet?
- 2 What are the advantages and disadvantages of virtual teamwork?
- 3 Why might an international company decide against virtual teamwork?

Task

- 1 You work for a global company. It has five key regions: North America; Latin America; Europe; the Middle East and North Africa; and Asia. The head office is in the Netherlands. You need to set up new working practices to allow for better and more effective teamwork across the different regions. Read this information about the international meetings, training sessions, and conferences that take place throughout the year.

Event	When / where	Who travels	Details
Sales conferences	One per year in June / July	All sales managers from all regions	Attend three-day conference in one of the regions.
Product training sessions	Four per year in varying regions	Product manager and several product developers from head office	Run two-day sessions for local sales reps covering several new products.
Marketing meetings	Several times per year in each of the regions	Marketing and R&D personnel from head office	Visit regional sales teams to discuss sales and marketing strategy.
Finance meetings	Several times a year in different regions	Finance controllers from head office	Visit finance teams in all the regions for a one-day meeting to look at the books and discuss future strategy.
General conferences	One every two years in the Netherlands	Managers and senior workers from all regions	To analyse results, share ideas and develop strategy. Includes social events.

- 2 Work in small groups, divided into two parts – A and B. Group A turn to File 21 on page 140. Group B, turn to File 28 on page 142. Read the information and make notes.
- 3 Share the information from your files and discuss what to do about all the international meetings, etc. in 1. Decide what changes you will make and when.
- 4 Present your plans to the rest of the class.

The Expert View

Early in a project it's important to create a positive working environment where team members can learn to trust and support each other. Social interaction and understanding of cultural differences are essential to obtaining commitment from all members. It's also important to identify individual strengths and role preferences. The team needs to appoint a leader to provide a framework for working towards defined outcomes or collective goals. As the project becomes more task focused, the team dynamic may shift from performing as a group to becoming a collection of individuals.

Raj Mulvadi, Manish Singh, Simone Taylor, David York, Full-time MBA graduates
Cranfield School of Management

Case study



9 | Logistics

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about logistics and supply chains
- Placing and handling orders
- Leaving voicemail messages
- Using reported speech to talk about problems or disagreements

Case study

- Solving a logistics problem

Starting point

- 1 What does the term 'logistics' mean?
- 2 Have you ever experienced problems with delivery of goods at home or at work? What happened?

Working with words | Logistics and supply chains

- 1 How long would you expect to wait for a new computer after ordering it?
- 2 Read this article and answer questions 1–2.
 - 1 How does Dell do business differently from other companies?
 - 2 How does this affect its suppliers?

Dell does it differently

Conventional **manufacturers** have to keep supplies of **raw materials** in order to produce their goods. Ordinary **retailers** too, have to keep the appropriate stock levels to satisfy their **clients'** needs. Enormous sums of money are tied up in this **inventory**. By contrast, Dell only builds once it has received an order and delivery takes on average seven to ten working days from the date the order is placed. By dealing directly with consumers through mailshots, advertisements, and the Internet, it bypasses

distributors and shopkeepers. And Dell's performance is truly breathtaking: its factories construct 80,000 machines per day and it can operate without **warehouses**. When an order is placed, the firm orders **components** from their **suppliers**. In addition, suppliers are expected to give credit even though Dell is paid in advance. This means that Dell has already been paid by its customers before it has to pay its own bills. Everything is so **streamlined** that it demands expert logistics and management of the **supply chain**.



3 Match the words in bold from the text in 2 to definitions 1–11.

- 1 people who sell products to the public: _____
- 2 stock: _____
- 3 the place where goods are stored: _____
- 4 parts you need to construct something: _____
- 5 designed for optimal efficiency: _____
- 6 the series of processes and companies involved in making and selling a product: _____
- 7 customers: _____
- 8 the 'middleman' between the manufacturer and retailer: _____
- 9 providers of goods: _____
- 10 producers: _____
- 11 the basic substances used to make something: _____

- 4 Work with a partner. Talk about the differences between Dell and a traditional supply chain. Use words from the list to complete the two flow charts.

distributor retailer manufacturer (x2) customer (x2) supplier (x2)

- 1 Traditional supply chain

supplier _____

- 2 Dell supply chain

supplier _____

- 5 36▷ Steve Zackon also works in the computer business. Listen to this interview and answer questions 1–3.

- 1 What are the main differences between his business and Dell?
- 2 How does he keep control of his stock?
- 3 How does Steve follow the progress of his orders?

- 6 36▷ Listen again. Complete the phrases in *italics*.

- 1 We have to keep a lot of components _____ *stock*.
- 2 How do you make sure that you don't *run* _____?
- 3 It tells us what we have left, if it's _____ *order* ...
- 4 You never want to *run* _____ *of* basic items.
- 5 It's really not good to be _____ *of stock*.
- 6 It just warns us we're *low* _____ *stock*.
- 7 You don't want to *stock* _____ *on* components ...
- 8 If there's an essential package, I _____ *track of* it very closely.

- 7 Match five of the phrases in *italics* from 6 to pictures a–e.



» For more exercises, go to Practice file 9 on page 118.

- 8 Work with a partner. Ask and answer questions 1–6. Talk about work and / or home.

- 1 Have you got anything on order at the moment?
- 2 What important supplies are you running low on?
- 3 How often do you run out of something essential?
- 4 When was the last time something you wanted to buy was out of stock?
- 5 What do you like to stock up on?
- 6 How do you keep track of your spending?

- 9 Work with a partner and take turns to

- say what you can do to make sure you don't run out of essential supplies at work
- describe what you know about your company's supply chain.

Exchanging information | Placing and handling orders



- 1** Gisele Kern works for a computer assembler in Hamburg. Read her email to Composource, a Singapore-based supplier, and answer questions 1–4.

- 1 What does she want to order?
- 2 Is she a regular customer?
- 3 When does she want delivery?
- 4 How will she pay?

✉

From: giselekern@abracomp.com
Subject: Order – motherboards

Dear Sir / Madam

I would like to place an order for 2,000 motherboards. This is a repeat order. We need these urgently so please send them asap. Please charge it to our account as usual.

Kind regards,
Gisele Kern
Abracomp

- 2** Underline the useful phrases for placing an order in the email in 1.

- 3** 37▷ Two weeks later, Gisele is still waiting for the components. She calls her supplier, Composource, to find out what is happening. Listen and complete the supplier's information.

Account: <i>Abracomp</i>	Quantity: <i>2,000</i>
Account reference:	Dispatched: Yes / No
Date of order:	Date and time dispatched:
Product description:	

- 4** 37▷ Listen again and complete these phrases.

- 1 I'm _____ an order I placed two weeks ago.
- 2 I'd like to _____ what has happened to it.
- 3 I see. Can I take your _____?
- 4 When did you _____ the order?
- 5 We put it _____ to our warehouse.
- 6 _____ my information, it was dispatched that afternoon.
- 7 Something _____ gone wrong.
- 8 I'm not _____ this at all.
- 9 Could you _____ for me?
- 10 Certainly, _____ immediately.
- 11 This is a _____ problem for me.
- 12 I'll be _____ I can.
- 13 I really want to know what's _____ to it.

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 9** on page 118.

Tip | Clarifying

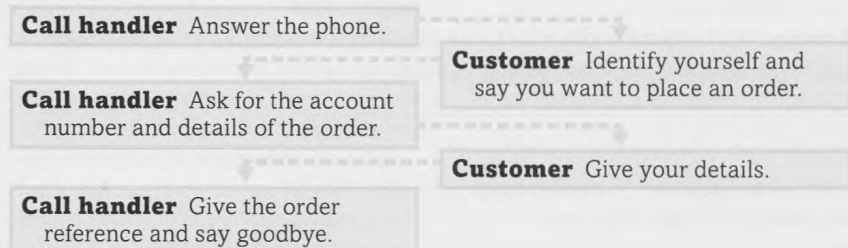
Remember that to clarify spelling, we can use common words (names, cities, countries) to illustrate a letter.

That's P for Peter, A for Australia.
For easily confused numbers (18 and 80, etc.), say each individual digit after the number.

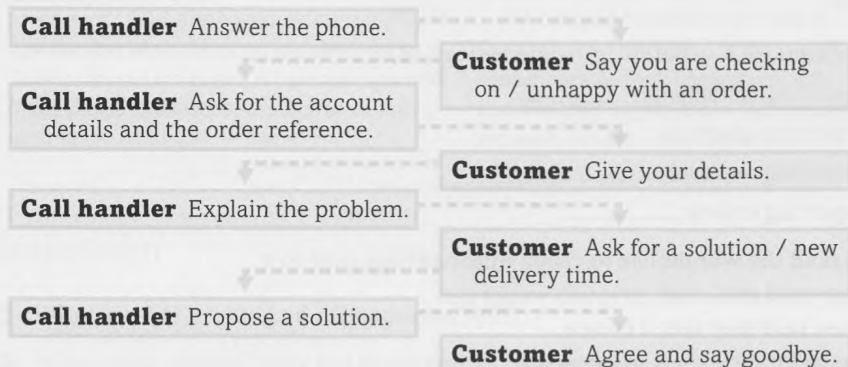
The number is eighteen – one, eight.

- 5 Work with a partner. Take turns to role-play two situations using this flow chart. In one situation you will be a customer, and in the second situation a call handler. In each situation you will have two conversations. Student A, turn to File 22 on page 140. Student B, turn to File 30 on page 142.

Conversation 1



Conversation 2



i » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Placing an order

I'd like to place an order.
This is a repeat order.
Please send them asap.
Please charge it to my account.

Asking for details

Do you have an account with us?
Can / could I take / have your account details, please?
When did you place the order?
Can I ask when you placed the order?

Checking on an order

I'd like to find out about an order.
I'm chasing / following up an order.
Could you check it out for me?
I really want to know what's happened to it.

Explaining what happened

We put it (straight) through to ...
According to my information, ...
It was dispatched on ...

Complaining

I'm not happy about this.
This is a real problem for me.
This is unacceptable.

Promising action

I'll look into it immediately.
I'll check it out straight away.
I'll find out.
I'll get back to you (within the hour).
I'll be as quick as I can.

i » Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to leave a voicemail message

- 38► Listen to three recorded messages. What are the instructions?
- Put phrases a–h below into categories 1–4.
 - Leaving a contact number: _____
 - Giving the time of your call: _____
 - Identifying yourself: _____
 - Giving a reason for the call: _____
 - Hi / Hello, this is ...
 - Call me back on ...
 - This is a message for ...
 - I was just wondering if ...
 - It's 6.30 p.m.
 - You can reach me on ...
 - I'm calling at ...
 - I was just calling about / to ...
- 39► In what order would you do 1–4 in 2? Listen to a message and compare it with your answer.
- Work with a partner. Take turns leaving these messages.
 - You are arriving at the airport at 3.30 p.m. Your flight number is HG781. You hope someone can meet you. Your mobile number is 0773 654989.
 - You want to know when your car will be ready. Leave a message at the garage. Give your contact details.

Language at work | Reported speech

1 40▷ Linda works for Composource. She is checking on an order for their customer, Gisele Kern. Listen to their conversation.

- 1 What is the problem with the order?
- 2 What solution does Gisele ask for?

2 Read sentences 1–4 and write what was actually said.

- 1 I asked the warehouse to check what had happened to it.
'Can you _____?'
- 2 They told me it had gone two weeks ago.
'It _____.'
- 3 They said they'd sent it by sea.
'We _____.'
- 4 I asked if they knew where it was.
'Do _____?'

3 Put sentences a–e below into categories 1–4.

- 1 Reporting statements: _____
 - 2 Reporting questions: _____
 - 3 Reporting requests: _____
 - 4 Reporting orders: _____
- a I asked the warehouse to check what had happened to it.
b They told me it had gone two weeks ago.
c They said they sent it by sea.
d I asked if they knew where it was.
e I'm sure I told them to send it by courier when I placed the order.

4 Complete these rules with *say* or *tell*.

- 1 We _____ something.
- 2 We _____ someone something.
- 3 We _____ something to someone.

» For more information and exercises, go to Practice file 9 on page 119.

5 41▷ Gisele is listening to a voicemail message from Linda. Listen and complete her notes.

Message from: _____
Time: _____
Message: Have sent _____ by _____
Linda told carrier this was _____
Arriving in _____
Reference / tracking number: _____

6 Gisele's boss, Peter, is very unhappy about the mix-up. Work with a partner and role-play a conversation between Gisele and Peter. Gisele – report back on Linda's message. Peter – ask questions and make comments.

7 Work in small groups. Think of a time when you had a disagreement or a problem with a colleague, a client, or a supplier. Tell your group what happened and what was said.

Solving a logistics problem

Background

DIY retailer calls in logistics experts

Castorama Polska belongs to the Kingfisher group of companies. Kingfisher is the third-largest home improvement retailer worldwide and has over 680 stores in eleven countries.

Castorama is the market leader in Poland with more than 30 stores and over 6,000 employees. Its products are sourced from around 700 suppliers in Asia, Europe, and Poland. Castorama's first store opened in Warsaw in 1997. In the following years the business in Poland grew rapidly, but so did their operational and economic challenges. As the number of stores grew, and demand for their products increased, it became more and more difficult to distribute stock to all their customers on time.

Each Castorama store operated as a 'logistically independent' unit – they each had different stock requirements and different ordering systems. Because there was no overall strategy, it was difficult to coordinate supply and demand. As a result, stock was often delayed or even lost, and orders quickly became outdated. The company's logistics costs went up, delays in orders increased, and customer satisfaction started to go down, ultimately leading to lost sales.

The company needed help to solve this problem. They called in the logistics consultants, Maersk Logistics, to help improve their supply chain, reduce costs, and increase customer satisfaction.

The Expert View

Logistics is the process of creating a framework for the flow of resources within a business. Supply chain management is the management of relationships with suppliers, distributors and customers – its aim is to coordinate the different processes within the business, and between customers and suppliers. For effective supply chain management, both individuals and organizations need to learn how to build relationships and work together. To solve logistics and supply chain problems we need Technical Intelligence (IQ) as well as Emotional Intelligence (EQ) – our ability to build relationships.

Richard Wilding, Professor of Supply Chain Risk Management
Cranfield School of Management

Discussion

- 1 What kind of products do Castorama sell?
- 2 What went wrong? Why did these things happen?
- 3 What are the benefits of a well-designed logistics system?
- 4 What changes would you advise Castorama to make?
- 5 Turn to File 24 on page 141 to find out how Maersk helped Castorama to make changes. Did you have the same ideas?

Task

You and your partner work for a logistics consultancy like Maersk Logistics. You have been called in by Toyztime, a large, growing chain of toy stores based in England. Toyztime is losing sales because of logistics problems. Like Castorama Polska, each of the 150 Toyztime stores operates as a 'logistically independent' unit. You and your partner have collected information from people who were once regular customers and from employees at Toyztime. You will discuss and analyse this information and then make recommendations to the company directors.

- 1 Student A, turn to File 32 on page 143. You have collected information from Toyztime customers. Student B, turn to File 42 on page 145. You have collected information from employees. Take turns to report your findings to your partner.
- 2 Work with your partner. Make a list of the six logistics problems that need to be solved and discuss what can be done. Use your own ideas and ideas from Maersk Logistics' solution for Castorama (see File 24 on page 141).
- 3 Present your solution to another group.



Case study

10 Facilities

Learning objectives in this unit

- Describing your place of work
- Making suggestions and recommendations
- Linking ideas
- Using nouns and quantifiers to talk about facilities

Case study

- Organizing a cause marketing event

Starting point

- 1 Name as many places of work as you can. Which ones would you most like to work in and which would you least like to work in? Why?
- 2 Look at the picture of the building in the text on this page. What sort of place do you think it is? Would you like to visit it? Why / why not?

Working with words | Describing a place of work

1 Read this article and answer questions 1–3.

- 1 What makes this place of work really different?
- 2 What facilities does it offer visitors?
- 3 How many different words for buildings can you find?

Dream factory

Does this complex look like an opera house? Actually, it has hosted Dresden Opera's highly successful production of *Carmen*, but ordinarily, it is tourists and customers who are welcomed to this state-of-the-art car plant. For a start, the Volkswagen 'Glass Factory' houses an interactive experience for learning about VW. A well-equipped and spacious customer centre invites buyers to choose the most up-to-date model, with specific colours and interiors. The ground floor houses a fine restaurant, but the amazing thing is that it stands in a city-centre park next to Dresden's beautifully-maintained baroque museums and churches.



2 Find words in the text in 1 that mean the opposite of these negative adjectives.

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------------------|
| 1 badly-equipped: _____ | 3 cramped: _____ |
| 2 old-fashioned: _____ | 4 run-down: _____ |

3 42▷ Listen to people visiting three different workplaces. Which adjectives from 2 can be used to describe each workplace they talk about?

- 4 The speakers in 3 use adverbs like *very* to intensify the adjectives. Complete this scale with other adverbs from the list.

pretty fairly quite not exactly extremely really

weak intensifier ● ————— ● strong intensifier

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 10 on page 120.

- 5 Work with a partner. Add a suitable adverb from 4 to sentences 1–7 and take turns saying them.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1 Your new offices are amazing. | 5 It's state-of-the-art. |
| 2 It's all well designed. | 6 The offices are not modern. |
| 3 All the machines are old. | 7 This is a successful company. |
| 4 Everyone is motivated. | |

- 6 42▷ Listen again and compare your sentences in 5.

- 7 Work with a partner. Look at this website with a range of offices for rent. Take turns to choose a property and describe it to your partner. Use adjectives from the list and adverbs from 4. Your partner must guess which property it is.

well maintained wide spacious well equipped well located secure

Example: A *These offices are fairly well located. The meeting room is not exactly spacious but there's a pretty wide range of telecom services.*

B *Is it property 1?*

Top Office Rentals

Our rating: 5 = Excellent, 1 = Poor

Property 1: Fallows Court Offices



5 individual offices on 3rd floor of four-storey building
 Location: 3 (mainline station 1 km)
 Maintenance / presentation: 2
 Range of telecom services: 4
 Conferencing facilities (1 meeting room): space = 2; equipment = 5
 Security: 4

Property 2: High Towers



1 open-plan office (10 people) + 3 individual offices located on ground floor
 Location: 5 (mainline station 500 m)
 Maintenance / presentation: 4
 Range of telecom services: 3
 Conferencing facilities (3 meeting rooms): space = 4; equipment = 3
 Security: 5

Property 3: Watson's Wharf



Up to 30 individual offices + 2 open-plan offices (up to 20 people in each)
 Location: 2 (mainline station 3 km)
 Maintenance / presentation: 4
 Range of telecom services: 5
 Conferencing facilities (6 meeting rooms): space = 5; equipment = 4
 Security: 4

- 8 Work with a partner. Take turns to describe the following. Use as many adverb + adjective combinations as you can.

- | | |
|--|-----------------------------|
| • your place of work | • your company headquarters |
| • your favourite building in the world | • a place where you relax |

① » Interactive Workbook » Glossary

Tip | Asking for descriptions

When asking for a description of a person, place, film, job, etc. say:

What is / are ... like?

Don't say:

How is ... like?

Do say:

What are your new offices like?

What is the CEO like?

Meetings | Making suggestions and recommendations



- 1 How do you make suggestions in your company? By email? Comment forms? Do you use a suggestion box?
- 2 Complete the comments below from a suggestion box using phrases from the list.
why don't have you thought about we could always couldn't we do

Comment form

Because so many women work here now,
1 _____ we have a crèche for young
children? Then parents wouldn't have so many
problems with childcare. And 2 _____
see our children at lunchtimes, which would also be
good for motivation.

Comment form

I don't want to complain about the new relaxation room – it's
extremely comfortable and spacious. But 3 _____
having some entertainment in there? I read about employees
at Microsoft where they have a special room called an Anarchy
Zone. They can play computer games, table football, or watch
MTV. 4 _____ something like that?

- 3 43▷ An architect is making initial recommendations to a facilities manager for a new office layout. They have looked at employee suggestions and started to draw up plans for it. They are discussing ideas for a crèche and a relaxation area. Listen and answer questions 1–2.
 - 1 Why can they only choose one of the ideas?
 - 2 Which one do they choose and why?
- 4 Choose the correct answer from the words in *italics*.
 - 1 Well, it might prove *difficult* / *difficulties* to have both.
 - 2 I think we should consider *have* / *having* ...
 - 3 Besides, I have a few *reserves* / *reservations* about ...
 - 4 You might be *better* / *the best* off without it ...
 - 5 I'd rather not *have* / *having* it.
 - 6 I'd recommend *to put* / *putting* it here.
- 5 43▷ Listen again and tick (✓) the responses you hear in the meeting.
 - 1 I really like it. ____
 - 2 Good idea. ____
 - 3 Sorry, but I don't think that would work. ____
 - 4 I'm not sure. ____
 - 5 Great! ____
 - 6 Exactly. ____

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 10 on page 120.

- 6** Work with a partner. An architect is redesigning your office space. Look at these two styles of office and read about some advantages and disadvantages for each in the table below. Can you add any more?



	Style A	Style B
Advantages	friendly, easy to communicate	good for concentration, private
Disadvantages	noisy, harder for private conversation	not as social, old-fashioned

- 7** Now prepare and give your recommendations for one of the office styles in 6 using phrases from 4. Student A, promote style A. Student B, promote style B. Respond to the recommendations you hear. Try to come to an agreement with your partner.

Example: A I'd recommend having an open-plan office because ...

B I think we should consider building closed offices because ...

- 8** Work in small groups. Imagine your company lets you have an Anarchy Zone – an area to relax and forget about work for a few minutes – with four items in it.

- 1 Make suggestions for what you would put in your Anarchy Zone. For example, a TV, computer games, books, etc. Give reasons for these suggestions. Respond to others' ideas. Decide on four items you will have in the zone.
- 2 Present your final recommendations to the rest of the class.
- 3 Comment on the other groups' recommendations.

📄 » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Suggesting

What / How about (+ -ing)?
 Why don't we (+ verb)?
 Maybe we should (+ verb) ...
 Maybe / Perhaps we could (+ verb) ...
 Couldn't we (+ verb) ...
 Have you thought about (+ -ing) ...
 We could always (+ verb) ...

Recommending

I think we should consider (+noun / -ing) ...
 We might be better off (+ -ing) ...
 It's probably worth (+ -ing) ...
 It might prove (+ adjective) ...
 I have a few reservations about (+ noun / -ing) ...
 I'd rather not (+ verb) ...
 I'd recommend (+ that / -ing) ...
 It would be better (+ infinitive) ...

Responding

I really like it.
 It's / That's a good idea.
 Sorry, but I don't think that would work.
 I'm not sure.
 Great.
 Exactly.

📄 » Interactive Workbook
 » Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to link ideas

- 1** Read sentences 1–5. Underline the two reasons given in each sentence. What word or phrase links the reasons?

- 1 I can't apply for the job because it's in Madrid. Besides, I don't have the right experience.
- 2 We chose this design because it's very modern and on top of that, it's cheaper.
- 3 Starting work at 8.00 a.m. means I avoid rush hour and also have longer evenings.
- 4 I like it here – my new colleagues are very helpful, as well as being friendly.
- 5 The company offers flexitime, which creates a better working atmosphere, and in addition to that, we have increased productivity.

- 2** Work with a partner. Talk about the topics below. Join the two reasons using the linkers from 1 above.

Example: I want a new job because I dislike my current boss and also, the pay is very low.

- 1 New job: dislike my current boss + pay is very low
- 2 Buy new car: current car is ten years old + it often breaks down
- 3 Take a holiday: very tired + no days off work for a year
- 4 Study English: important for work + useful for holidays abroad



Language at work | Nouns and quantifiers

- 1 Work with a partner. Make a list of all the facilities that a workplace can have. Compare your lists with another pair.
- 2 44▷ Listen to three employees commenting on their facilities at work. Which of the facilities in pictures a–c does each employee comment on?

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____

- 3 44▷ Listen again and complete sentences 1–7.

- 1 There isn't _____ *space* in them to put personal belongings.
- 2 And when I get changed, they don't hold _____ *clothes*.
- 3 Perhaps if we had _____ *shelves*, it might help.
- 4 It would be a great idea to have _____ *running machines* ...
- 5 _____ *employees* only have _____ *time* after work ...
- 6 There aren't _____ *places* in the factory to relax.
- 7 There are _____ *chairs* in that room ...

- 4 Put the nouns in *italics* from 3 into these categories.

- 1 Countable nouns: _____
- 2 Uncountable nouns: _____

- 5 Complete this table with the quantifiers you wrote in 3. Some words can go in both columns.

quantifiers for uncountable nouns,
e.g. *time*

some

quantifiers for countable nouns,
e.g. *chairs*

some

- 6 Which of the quantifiers from 5 can you use to

- 1 talk about small quantities / amounts? _____
- 2 talk about large quantities / amounts? _____
- 3 ask questions about quantities / amounts? _____
- 4 make negative statements about quantities / amounts? _____

- 7 Complete sentences 1–5 with words from 6.

- 1 There is _____ extra space in my office – most of my cupboards are empty.
- 2 Have you got _____ spare time?
- 3 There's only _____ coffee left.
- 4 _____ people use our fitness room – but most people don't have _____ time.
- 5 We don't have _____ space, I'm afraid.

» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 10** on page 121.

- 8 Work with a partner. Changes have been made to the workplace facilities in pictures a–c in 2. Turn to File 29 on page 142 and talk about the changes.

Example: There's a lot of space in the lockers now.

- 9 Work with a partner. Make a list of the facilities you have or would like to have at work. Tell your partner why and how they are used, and what you think of them.

Example: We have a canteen because there aren't many restaurants nearby.

There aren't any showers because there isn't enough space.

② » Interactive Workbook » Exercises and Tests

Organizing a cause marketing event

Background

All for a good cause

Cause marketing is a type of marketing where a typical, 'for profit' business and a non-profit organization (for example, a charity like Unicef or Médecins Sans Frontières) work together. This cooperation has benefits for both partners. In the United States, companies spend more than a billion dollars per year on cause marketing and this amount is increasing.

Example 1

The French-owned company, Yoplait®, specializes in yogurt and desserts, and offers some 2,500 products in approximately 50 countries worldwide. In the United States, Yoplait® is working with the Susan G. Komen Breast Cancer Foundation to help raise awareness and money for research into breast cancer through its Save Lids to Save Lives® programme. This asks customers to send the

company their pink Yoplait® yogurt lids. For every lid received, the company gives a sum of money to the Foundation.

Example 2

The UK-based mobile-phone company, Vodafone, is well known as a sponsor of the European football UEFA Champions League. Vodafone is also working with the National Autistic Society (NAS) to provide help for people with autism and their families. The company's role includes:

- setting up a database of services for people with autism which can be accessed online or by mobile phone
- paying for advertising and marketing campaigns to publicize the work of NAS and to raise awareness about autism
- recycling old mobile phones and giving the profits to NAS.

Discussion

- 1 What are the advantages of cause marketing for both partners?
- 2 Why do you think these companies chose to work with these charities?
- 3 What possible disadvantages are there in this kind of arrangement?

Task

Your company produces bicycles. For the last two years the company has worked with a children's charity to promote health and fitness among young people. Last year, you held an open day at the factory for local people. The aim was to raise the company's profile in the community, and to create interest and raise money for the charity. You are on the committee to plan and organize another similar event this year.

- 1 Work in groups of three. Student A, turn to File 23 on page 140. Student B, turn to File 31 on page 142. Student C, turn to File 35 on page 144. Read the information in your files.
- 2 Take turns to make recommendations for this year's event. Respond to each others' recommendations and make further suggestions.
- 3 Decide on your final recommendations and present these to the class.

The Expert View

Marketing a corporate brand today means developing sustainable business practices, and being more socially responsible. Major supermarkets like Tesco and Wal-Mart have started to improve all aspects of their businesses, from energy use and transportation to store merchandizing. This also involves the cooperation of their suppliers, from the big multinationals like Unilever and Frito-Lay, to smaller local suppliers. International banks, such as HSBC, are committing billions of dollars to promote research into climate change and to support the development of sustainable products and services. Businesses need to decide how they can reduce their effect on the environment, and what advantage their brand image will gain as a result.

Simon Knox, Professor of Brand Marketing
Cranfield School of Management

Case study

11

Decisions

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about decision-making
- Participating in a discussion
- Being persuasive
- Using the first and second conditionals to talk about future possibilities

Activity

- The decision game

Starting point

1 Read how four people make decisions. Who are you most like?

'I trust my instinct. If I think too much about something, I often get it wrong.'

'Sometimes I rush into decisions too quickly and I often regret what I have done.'

'I make a list of the advantages and disadvantages of each option before I decide.'

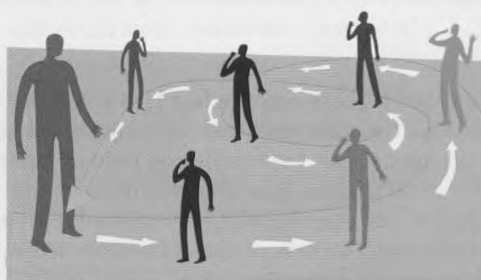
'I ask people I trust what they think before I make up my mind. I find it hard to make decisions on my own.'

2 Is there a difference between the way you make decisions at work and at home?

Working with words | Decision-making

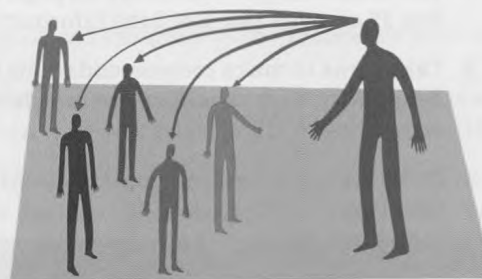
1 Read these texts and look at the diagrams of three decision-making processes. How are they different?

Suma is a large healthfood wholesaler. The company is a cooperative and practises a democratic decision-making process. All employees can take part in the decision-making.



Mitsubishi Motor Sales of America is changing the way it does business. 'We now have a completely collaborative process using a consensus decision-making model,' says Pierre Gagnon, Executive Vice President. This means that ideas are put forward by management, and are passed to other company employees to get their opinions.

At the Ford Motor Company, senior management members of the Strategy and Business Governance group decide on the direction of the company and make the necessary decisions.



2 45, 46, 47▷ Franz, Stella, and Aidan are talking about how decisions are made where they work. Listen and match them to the companies in 1.

3 Which decision-making process in 1 is closest to that in your place of work?

4 45▷ Listen to Franz again. Complete these words.

- 1 a discussion where different expert opinions are heard before a decision is made: *con* _____
- 2 an argument or open conflict: *con* _____
- 3 something you agree to accept or do in order to reach an agreement or end an argument: *con* _____
- 4 an agreement where you get part of what you want: *com* _____
- 5 general agreement between a group of people: *con* _____

5 46▷ Listen to Stella again. Match words from the list to definitions 1–9.

*go for brainstorm options in favour of majority
hierarchy backing put forward carry out*

- 1 the power and decision-making structure of an organization: _____
- 2 generate ideas imaginatively and energetically: _____
- 3 present / propose: _____
- 4 choices / alternatives: _____
- 5 support / approval: _____
- 6 most of the people: _____
- 7 for, not against: _____
- 8 choose: _____
- 9 perform / execute: _____

6 47▷ Match the verbs in A to the nouns in B to make phrases. There is sometimes more than one combination. Then listen again and compare your answers.

A	B
put forward	your mind
have	major decisions
express	a consensus
make	an idea
reach	confrontation
evaluate	a suggestion
carry out	a say
avoid	ideas
make up	an opinion

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 11 on page 122.

7 Work with a partner. Ask and answer questions using the phrases you made in 6.

Example: A When did you last put forward an idea that was accepted?

B I last put forward an idea that was accepted about a month ago.

8 Work in small groups. Have a discussion on these two topics.

- You have to decide on a dress code (what to wear at work) for all members of staff.
- Someone has suggested that everybody should have the same salary, whatever their position in the company or their responsibilities.

9 Tell the rest of the class how your discussion went.

- 1 What different stages did you follow?
- 2 How much confrontation, consensus, compromise, and consultation were involved?
- 3 Who put forward some good ideas and who expressed opinions?

② » Interactive Workbook » Glossary

Tip | How to introduce a question

To signal that you are going to ask a question, you can begin with *so*, *now*, or *and*.

So what happens if the workforce doesn't agree?

And does this lead to strikes?

Now how do you agree on something like that?

Meetings | Participating in a discussion



1 48▷ In 2002, Stefan, Ilse, and Patrick founded an independent computer games shop in the backstreets of a large historic town. It is popular with students and young people who live in the area. A new shopping centre is opening outside town and they are discussing whether they should move their business there. Listen to three extracts from their discussion. Who

- 1 thinks they should start to think about growing? ____
- 2 mentions how easy it will be to park at the shopping centre? ____
- 3 reminds everyone about who their customers are? ____
- 4 suggests keeping the shop in town as well as going to the shopping centre? ____
- 5 is worried that there won't be any well-located shops left in the shopping centre? ____
- 6 would like to wait and see what big retailers plan to do? ____
- 7 suggests asking for independent advice? ____

2 48▷ Listen again. Put phrases a–l below into categories 1–6.

- 1 Giving an opinion: _____
 - 2 Agreeing: _____
 - 3 Asking if there is a general agreement: _____
 - 4 Acknowledging what someone else says: _____
 - 5 Summarizing what someone has said: _____
 - 6 Asking for suggestions for future action: _____
-
- a Personally, I think we should ...
 - b I agree with you, ...
 - c I hear what you're saying, (but) ...
 - d That's a nice idea, (but) ...
 - e As far as I'm concerned, it's ...
 - f I take your point, (but) ...
 - g According to ...,
 - h So if I've understood you correctly, ...
 - i So, where do we go from here?
 - j So are we all agreed, then?
 - k Yes, that's fine with me.
 - l Me too.

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 11** on page 122.

- 3** Work with a partner. Take turns to choose a statement about using email from the list of pros and cons and exchange opinions. Use expressions from 2. You can add your own ideas if you want.

Example: A As far as I'm concerned, email is the best form of communication in business because it's so fast and inexpensive.

B I hear what you're saying but you don't always get an answer straight away.

A Yes, good point.

Pros: Email is the best form of communication in business because

- it's so fast and inexpensive
- you can send documents as attachments – no need to wait for the post
- you can pick up messages wherever you are in the world
- it gives you more time to think than a phone call does
- it means you have an accurate record of communications with a customer.

Cons: Email is not that great because

- you don't always get an answer straight away
- it's not as private as a letter
- you don't always have access to a computer
- it's not as personal as a handwritten letter
- it's easy to delete messages by mistake and therefore lose important information.

- 4** Work in small groups. A number of people where you work want your organization to become more ethical and democratic. Have a discussion on these proposals and decide whether to accept them or not.

- 1 All decisions will be made democratically using a 'works parliament'. Each member of staff will have one vote for every year they have worked at the firm (with a maximum of five votes).
- 2 For the health of employees, from now on the staff restaurant will only serve sugar-free soft drinks, decaffeinated coffee, and vegetarian meals.
- 3 As parking at the company is limited, only cars which carry at least two employees will be permitted to park.
- 4 At the moment, the highest paid worker earns ten times more than the lowest paid. This will be reduced to a four-to-one ratio.

 » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Giving your opinion

Personally, I think / feel ...

I think we should ...

In my opinion, ...

From my point of view, ...

As I see it, ...

As far as I'm concerned, ...

Giving someone else's opinion

X says that we should ...

According to X ...

X maintains that ...

Agreeing / disagreeing

I agree.

Exactly.

Absolutely.

I couldn't agree more.

I don't agree.

Yes, but ...

I'm not (quite) sure about that ...

That's fine with me.

Acknowledging what someone else says

Yes, good point.

I take your point.

I hear what you're saying, ...

I can understand what you're saying.

Yes, fair enough.

Checking understanding

So what you're saying is ...

So if I've followed what you've

said, ...

So if I understand you correctly, ...

Reaching a decision

Does everyone agree?

Are we all agreed?

Is everyone happy with that?

 » Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to be persuasive

- 1 49▶** Listen to these extracts and note down the four phrases the speakers use to sound more persuasive.

- | | |
|---------|---------|
| 1 _____ | 3 _____ |
| 2 _____ | 4 _____ |

- 2** Match the phrases in 1 to meanings a–d.

- a I am about to mention something important we shouldn't forget. ____
- b Be reasonable. ____
- c I am going to tell the truth as I see it. ____
- d We need to be realistic. ____

- 3** Work with a partner or in small groups. Discuss the following statements. Give yourself a point for each time you use one of the phrases from 1.

- First impressions are nearly always the most reliable.
- Private health insurance creates inequality among people who are ill.
- All workers should receive a share of the company's profits.
- Two heads are always better than one.

Language at work | First and second conditionals

1 Read this email. What advice do you think Jeff will give?

Dear Jeff

I am writing to you to ask for your expert advice. We've got the opportunity to relocate our computer games shop to a new out-of-town shopping centre. If we ¹*had / have* more money, we would keep the shop in town and open up at the shopping centre too. However, that's not an option for us. If we ²*don't keep / won't keep* this shop, we'll lose most of our current customers who are local students without cars. However, if we move, we ³*would / will* have a larger base of potential (and wealthy) customers.

We'd greatly appreciate it if you could advise us on this matter. Please could you let us know if you are able to do so asap.

Many thanks and best wishes

Ilse

2 Choose the correct answer from the words in *italics* in the email in 1.

3 Match sentences a–c below to meanings 1–3.

- 1 Something that might or might not happen and the result: ____
- 2 Something that is impossible or very unlikely to happen: ____
- 3 Something that is likely to happen: ____

- a If we **had** more money, we **would keep** the shop.
- b If we **don't keep** this shop, we'll **lose** most of our current customers.
- c If we **move**, we **will have** a larger base of potential customers.

4 Which word / phrase in *italics* in 1–2 means 'just imagine'? Which means 'if not'?

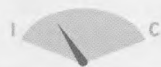
- 1 They won't be able to get to the shopping centre *unless* they have a car.
- 2 *What if* we kept the shop here and opened up in the shopping centre?

» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 11** on page 123.

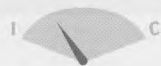
5 Work with a partner. Complete 1–7 using the meter on the left which tells you how likely the event is (*I* = impossible / unlikely, *C* = certain / likely).



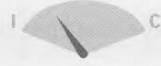
- 1 If I _____ (win) salesperson of the month competition, I _____ (go) to Prague to celebrate.



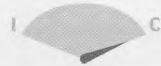
- 2 If our bosses _____ (listen to) us more it _____ (avoid) so much confrontation.



- 3 We _____ (understand) her arguments better if she _____ (explain) herself more clearly.



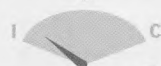
- 4 If people _____ (cooperate) more willingly, we _____ (make) faster progress.



- 5 What _____ (you / do) when you _____ (retire)?



- 6 What _____ (you / do) if they _____ (offer) you the job in New York?



- 7 How _____ (you / react) if your company _____ (relocate) to the other side of the country?

6 Work with a partner. Discuss what you will / would do if your

- company is / was relocated to another part of the country or abroad?
- firm is / was taken over by its main competitor?
- partner gets / got a new job a long way from home / abroad?
- boss's job becomes / became vacant?

The decision game

Work in small groups. You work at the Central Bank, a British bank with branches in most towns and cities. All of your call centres are based in the UK, in areas of high unemployment. You must make a series of decisions which will affect the future of these call centres. Work together and make your first decision by choosing option **a** or **b**. Start at 1. Follow the instructions.

Senior management want you to cut costs and improve profitability. In India, call centre workers are paid five times less than in the UK. You decide to

- a** keep the call centres in the UK and accept higher costs. **Go to 6.**
- b** investigate more fully the cost and benefits of moving the call centres. **Go to 2.**

Shareholders complain that you are less profitable than rival banks. They are still putting pressure on you to cut costs. You decide to

- a** please shareholders by closing some less profitable branches. **Go to 9.**
- b** organize a newspaper campaign explaining to the public why you want to keep the call centre jobs in the UK. **Go to 4.**

Your negotiations with the union have reached a crossroads. The union wants to reduce UK job losses to a minimum. You decide to

- a** keep just 150 UK call centre jobs and risk a strike. **Go to 14.**
- b** keep 400 UK jobs which will satisfy the union. **Go to 5.**

If you close the UK call centres, 1,000 jobs will be lost. You do not want to cause unnecessary panic because you are still at the investigation stage. You decide to

- a** be open about your plans. **Go to 8.**
- b** keep your plans confidential for the moment. **Go to 15.**

Customers are even angrier when they receive your letter. They don't care what your motives are. You decide to

- a** ignore the complaints. **Go to 13.**
- b** invest more money in staff training. **Go to 3.**

Union negotiations have been successful. Both sides have compromised. You have agreed to keep 250 UK jobs. The bank offers you a tough new mission which involves closing other unprofitable branches. You decide to

- a** accept their tough new mission. **Go to 10.**
- b** stay where you are, happy that you have survived a difficult moment. **Return to 1 or end here.**

The India call centre is now a success and complaints have dropped. However, an Indian worker now costs a third as much as a UK worker and soon will cost half as much. You will now have to look for a cheaper alternative or think of other places where costs might be cheaper. **Return to 1 or end here.**

UK call centre employees have heard about your possible plans to go to India. They want full consultation with the union. You decide to

- a** involve the union and discuss the plans with them. **Go to 11.**
- b** ignore the union and go ahead with your plans. **Go to 14.**

Angry customers contact Head Office and name you as personally responsible for the problems. Senior managers are happy to use you as a scapegoat. You are moved to manage a small branch in the countryside. It is the end of your ambitions. **Return to 1 or end here.**

A newspaper has run a campaign praising you as the patriotic bank. This is good for your image, but means that your hands could be tied in the future. **Return to 1 or end here.**

Your plan to close smaller branches will cost 500 jobs. This causes protest from the union and from customers who live near the small branches. You decide to

- a** carry on with the closures. **Go to 10.**
- b** reconsider other ways of cutting costs, including the call centre option. **Go to 2.**

There have been three one-day strikes in selected branches. You decide to

- a** face up to the union and refuse to change your position. **Go to 13.**
- b** re-open negotiations with the union. **Go to 12.**

Now you have solved the union problems, the call centre is going ahead. However, UK customers say there are often communication problems with the Indian-based call handlers. You decide to

- a** ask senior management to invest more money in staff training. **Go to 3.**
- b** send a letter to customers explaining the need to set up in India. **Go to 7.**

Going ahead with the branch closures loses the bank several thousand customers and gets a lot of negative publicity. You lose your job! **Return to 1 or end here.**

Someone has leaked the story about the India plans to the union. You are attacked in the press as an exporter of British jobs. You decide to

- a** deny everything and go ahead with the plans in secret. **Go to 14.**
- b** open up negotiations with the union. **Go to 11.**

Activity

12

Innovation

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about innovation and new ideas
- Giving a formal presentation
- Responding to difficult questions and comments
- Using superlative forms to talk about extremes

Case study

- Presenting innovative products

Starting point

- 1 Work with a partner. Put these twentieth-century innovations and inventions in order from the earliest (1) to the most recent (6).

- photocopier
- Velcro
- handheld calculator
- vacuum cleaner
- instant coffee
- parking meter

Check your answers in File 09 on page 137.

- 2 Which inventions and innovations of the twentieth century do you think were the most
 - important?
 - useful?

Working with words | Innovation and new ideas

- 1 When and where do you get your best ideas? At work? After lunch? In the middle of the night? When you're exercising? In the car?
- 2 Read this article and answer questions 1–2.
 - 1 Why did Mitchell Ditkoff and John Havens invent The Breakthrough Café?
 - 2 Would you like to go there?

Food for thought

The Breakthrough Café is the **brainchild** of Mitchell Ditkoff and John Havens. The aim is that customers will have at least one '**a-ha**' moment during an evening that is a combination of 'party, restaurant, and brainstorming session'.

Over a three-course meal, customers begin by meeting each other and reading their name badges. The name badge also contains the words 'How can I ...?' Each customer completes this with a question about an idea or **obstacle** in their life. For example, 'How can I start my own catering business?', 'How can I find someone to invest in my **prototype**?', 'How can I get a new job?' As well as discussing and giving advice to each other, there are 'Innowaiters' who serve food and drink, but also act as **facilitators** to encourage **innovative** ideas.

Ditkoff explains how he first **came up with** the **concept**. 'I've asked thousands of people: "Where do you get your best ideas? What is the **catalyst**?" Less than one per cent of people say they get their ideas at work. They get their ideas when they are happy, away from the office, late at night, and in the company of friends.'



- 3 Match the words in **bold** from the text in 2 to definitions 1–9.

- 1 an idea for something new: _____
- 2 an idea or invention of one person or group of people: _____
- 3 new and original: _____
- 4 when you suddenly realize or understand something: _____
- 5 people who help you: _____
- 6 something to cause change: _____
- 7 think of a new idea or plan: _____
- 8 something stopping you: _____
- 9 the first form of something new: _____

- 4 50▶ The article in 2 gives three examples of questions people might ask at the café. Listen to three conversations at the Breakthrough Café. Which question from the article does each person have on his / her badge?

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____

- 5 50▶ Listen again. Tick (✓) adjectives each speaker uses to describe the three categories in the table.

	Job / Company	Technology	Idea
dynamic	✓		
original			
reliable			
revolutionary			
simple			
sophisticated			
traditional			

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 12 on page 124.

- 6 Work with a partner. Discuss these questions and give reasons for your answers.

- Which of the adjectives in 5 describe your company or job?
- How would you describe the technology you use?

- 7 Read these quotes from people talking about ideas and obstacles in their lives. Work in small groups. Think of different ways to help these three people. Then tell the class.

1 'I have this really simple idea for setting up a cleaning company where we clean local companies and people's houses. The only problem is I have two small children who aren't at school yet. How can I do both?'

2 'My brainchild is a motorbike that runs on hydrogen, not petrol. I've already built a prototype, but how can I get the money to manufacture and market it?'

3 'I've retired with a pension but I'm bored. I have some money, but I don't know what to do with it. I don't want to work too hard. What could I do?'

- 8 Think back to all the ideas and discussions in 7 and answer questions 1–4.

- During the group discussion, did you hear any ideas which were
 - innovative?
 - original?
 - simple?
 - other?
 - revolutionary?
- Which was the best 'brainchild' you heard?
- Who was the most useful facilitator or catalyst in your group?
- What obstacles did you encounter?

- 9 Work with a partner and compare your answers to 8.

- 10 Write your own *How can I ...?* question.

- Tell the class your question and ask each person to give you an idea / solution.
- Choose your favourite idea and explain why you like it.

Example: *I like the idea that Antje came up with because it's simple but also very innovative and original.*

Tip | invention and innovation

An *invention* is a design of something new. An *innovation* is an idea or way of doing something that is completely different from anything that has gone before.

Presenting | Giving a formal presentation



- 1** Read this company mission statement. Do you have something similar for your company?

Bertran RL aims to create innovative and state-of-the-art conferencing technology products of the highest value, with the greatest reliability and simplicity we can offer. We achieve this with employees who deserve the very best in professional support and development.

Agenda

- 1 How we want to be seen
- 2 Current company situation
- 3 Finding a mission statement

sophisticated
traditional simple
 innovative
up-to-date
 reliable

- 2** 51▷ The PR Manager of Bertran RL is giving a presentation about rewriting their mission statement. Listen to her introduction. Correct the agenda.
- 3** 51▷ Put these phrases from the PR manager's introduction in the right order 1–7. Then listen again and check your answers.
- ___ a First, I'm going to talk ...
 - ___ b Feel free to ask questions ...
 - ___ c We have a lot to do, so let's start.
 - ___ d Good morning, everyone, and thanks for coming.
 - ___ e I'd like to begin by explaining ...
 - ___ f And finally, after coffee, we'll try to ...
 - ___ g Then, we'll try to ...
- 4** 52▷ Listen to the next part of the presentation. What do the coloured words on the slide represent?
- 5** 52▷ Listen again and complete phrases 1–3 for referring to visuals.
- 1 First of all, _____ slide.
 - 2 _____ it has a number of words that describe our company.
 - 3 _____ some words are in blue and some are in red.
- 6** 53▷ Listen to the final part of the presentation. Why does Rudi criticize mission statements? Do you agree with him?
- 7** 53▷ Correct the mistakes in 1–5. Then listen again and check your answers.
- 1 That's everything I want to tell for the moment.
 - 2 Thank you all for listen.
 - 3 The best reason for this meeting is to ...
 - 4 Are there any answers?
 - 5 We think it a good idea because ...

» For more exercises, go to **Practice file 12** on page 124.

- 8** Prepare and give a short presentation using as many of the phrases in 3, 5, and 7 as possible. Talk about one of the objects below. You have one minute to convince your partner why this object is the best or most useful in the world. Follow the four stages in the flow chart.

- pen
- mobile phone
- laptop
- MP3 player
- paper
- cash card

1 Introduce your object

I'm going to tell you about ...

2 Show your object

As you can see ...

3 Explain why

The best thing about it is ...

4 End the presentation

Thanks for listening ...

- 9** Prepare and give a longer presentation to your partner or the rest of class about how your customers view your company, service, or product. Design a slide with adjectives you think your customers would use. Organize the presentation like this.

- Introduce the aim and structure of the presentation.
- Present the slide and explain the main reasons for each adjective.
- Close the talk and answer any questions.

 » Interactive Workbook » Email

Key expressions

Starting

Good morning and thanks for coming.

I'm here today to ...

Let's start.

My name's ... and I'm going to tell you / talk about ...

I'd like to begin by (+ -ing) ...

Previewing

First, I'll / I'm going to ...

Then, we'll ...

And finally ...

Feel free to ask questions.

I'll take questions at the end.

Referring to visuals

Let's look at this ...

As you can see, ...

You'll notice that ...

Explaining reasons / benefits

The main reason for this meeting is ...

The best thing about this is ...

We think it's a good idea because ...

Closing

That's everything I want to say.

That brings me to the end of my presentation.

Thanks for listening.

Are there any (more) questions?

 » Interactive Workbook
» Phrasebank

Practically speaking | How to respond to difficult questions and comments

- 1** 54▶ Listen to the final part of a presentation. Tick (✓) the methods of responding to questions the presenter uses.

- 1 Ask for the question again. ____
- 2 Compliment the question. ____
- 3 Explain that you will answer the person later. ____
- 4 Understand their opinion, but disagree. ____
- 5 Say you don't understand the question. ____
- 6 Understand their opinion. ____

- 2** Match 1–6 in 1 to a–f.

- a Sorry, I couldn't hear you. ____
- b Yes, I know what you mean, but ... ____
- c Good question. ____
- d Sorry, I don't think I follow you. ____
- e I totally agree with you. ____
- f Can I get back to you on that one? ____

- 3** Work with a partner. Here are some difficult questions and comments from a presentation. Take turns to ask / say them, and answer using some of the techniques above.

‘Why did the company have its lowest profits ever this year?’

‘Why are sales of our latest product so low?’

‘What's the current sales situation in Brazil?’

‘How do you propose to satisfy increasing customer demand?’

‘I think we are risking losing our profit margin.’

Language at work | Superlative forms

- 1** Read this extract from a sales brochure for a Bertran RL conference-call system and correct the mistake in each line.

CallTerminal VVX 1000

Your conference room phone is one of your most valuablest assets. Multicell's CallTerminal VVX 1000 delivers best sound quality and picks up speech from six metres away – that's a furthest of any on the market. Conference-call participants are happiest with Multicell!

- 2** Read this article and answer questions 1–2.

- 1 What is DreamWorks famous for?
- 2 What is its new innovation?

For most people, DreamWorks Animation (DWA) is probably best known for producing films like *Toy Story* and, recently, *Shrek 2*, which was the third highest-grossing film of all time. However, the company's latest release isn't a film, but what may be the most sophisticated videoconferencing system the world has ever seen.

- 3** Underline the superlative forms in the article in 2.

- 4** Match extracts a–c to rules 1–3 about using the superlative.

- 1 To describe the maximum or minimum: _____
 - 2 To place something in a position after first place: _____
 - 3 With the present perfect to describe our experience of something: _____
- a ... **the most sophisticated** videoconferencing system the world has ever seen.
 b ... the company's **latest** release ...
 c ... the **third highest-grossing** film of all time.

» For more information and exercises, go to **Practice file 12** on page 125.

- 5** Work with a partner. Using the words in the table below, take turns to ask and answer questions. You will need to use the superlative form of the adjectives.

*Example: A What's **the worst** decision you've ever made?*

B Leaving my first company.

*A So what's **the second worst** decision you've ever made?*

B Joining this one!

What's / Who's the (second / third)	bad	country / place	you've ever	met?
	good	film		made?
	big	decision		had?
	nice	person		seen?
	beautiful	hotel		stayed at?
	friendly	idea		visited?
	exciting	experience		heard?

- 6** Work with a partner. Make a list of ways to communicate with colleagues and clients.

- 1 Which do you like best and why?
- 2 Which do you like least and why?

*Example: I like email **the best** because it's **the quickest** and **easiest** way to contact someone.*

Presenting innovative products

Background

Clever products

A clever car

The Kenguru is a car with a difference, designed specifically for wheelchair users. Built in Hungary, it is small, stylish and easy to park and gives users greater freedom and independence.

The Kenguru holds one passenger in a wheelchair. It doesn't have doors or seats like a normal car. To get in, the driver opens the extra large back door and rolls inside without leaving the wheelchair. The chair automatically locks into place inside the car. The controls are simpler than a normal car too – a joystick instead of a steering wheel means that drivers with limited arm mobility can easily control the vehicle.

The Kenguru is electrically powered. It has a range of up to 60 km and a top speed of 35–40 km/h, and costs about the same as a small family car.

An intelligent water pump

Tom Smith, a science graduate from Cambridge in the UK, has developed a new kind of pump which is powered by the sun's heat. This means it can be used in places that do not have electricity.

Tom is working on two possible uses for the pump. One use is to help supply water to farmers in parts of the developing world. The other, more commercial use is to create a more energy-efficient way of circulating hot water in central-heating systems.

The pump can raise water from several metres under the ground, so it is very useful for farmers in the developing world.

The pump has no moving parts and it can be produced very cheaply.

The Expert View

How can organizations become more innovative? Many senior managers want their companies to develop products and services that create new market opportunities. However, this is challenging because there are many elements to managing innovation. Companies need, for example, to develop better ways of discovering customer needs and to create the right 'culture of innovation'. These are issues that top managers need to devote sufficient time to. Don't neglect innovation – if you do, your organization will never reach its true potential.

Keith Goffin, Professor of Innovation and New Product Development
Cranfield School of Management

Discussion

- 1 What are the particular selling points of these two products?
- 2 Who are the customers for these products?
- 3 How can these products be marketed effectively?

Task

- 1 Work with a partner or in small groups.
 - 1 Brainstorm things that you would like to improve in your everyday life – for example, at home, in your workplace, in your local community.
 - 2 Choose one of these problems and brainstorm ways to improve or solve it. It could be a new product, invention, or idea for a new way of doing things or for adapting an existing product.
- 2 Prepare and give a presentation of your new brainchild to the class. You will need to
 - open the presentation
 - show a simple design of the new item / idea
 - explain why it is the best idea
 - describe your target market and explain how you would promote your product
 - close the presentation and answer any questions.



Case study



13 Breakdown

Learning objectives in this unit

- Talking about breakdowns and faults
- Discussing problems and offering advice
- Checking someone understands
- Using the language of advice and recommendation to offer help

Case study

- Managing a breakdown in service

Starting point

- 1 What kinds of breakdown can you think of?
- 2 Is it acceptable to produce goods and provide services that are not 100% perfect?
- 3 Which of these products would you be prepared to buy at a discounted price if they had a defect? Why / why not?
 - furniture
 - jewellery
 - food products
 - clothing
 - toys
 - electronic equipment
 - books
 - cars

Working with words | Breakdowns and faults

- 1 Read these extracts 1–3 from defect policy statements and match them to the products in pictures a–c.

1

In the case of product **failure**, please contact the number below to obtain a returns code. Please return the **defective** unit to us in its original packaging together with a description of the fault and a note of the returns code.



2

If you are not completely satisfied with the quality of our products or if the packaging is **damaged**, please retain the product and the packaging and return to the address above within 48 hours of receipt. Please include a note about the nature of the problem and state whether you would prefer a refund or replacement.



3

Products may be returned for product dissatisfaction, size changes and manufacturer **defect**. If a product is damaged we will pay for shipping.



- 2 Match the words in **bold** from the texts in 1 to definitions 1–4.

- 1 with a mistake or fault in it: _____
- 2 harmed or spoiled: _____
- 3 a mistake or fault: _____
- 4 case of something not working / functioning as expected: _____

3 Match 1–8 to a–h.

- 1 The campaign has **gone wrong** ... ____
 - 2 We can't do any work on our computers at the moment ... ____
 - 3 We didn't get the products in time for Christmas ... ____
 - 4 It has definitely **broken down** ... ____
 - 5 I need to exchange my new keyboard ... ____
 - 6 I can't open this file ... ____
 - 7 There must have been a **misunderstanding** ... ____
 - 8 We'll have to use the stairs ... ____
- a because it's **faulty** – the space bar doesn't work.
 - b because the lift is **out of order**.
 - c because the product has a major **flaw** and it won't be ready in time for the launch.
 - d because I asked for 40 but I got 14!
 - e because our supplier **let us down**. They are very **unreliable**.
 - f because the format of it is **incompatible** with the software I use.
 - g because the server is **down**. There must be a **bug** that needs to be fixed.
 - h because it won't do anything and this red light is on.

4 Which words in **bold** from the texts in 1 and from 3 would you normally use to talk about these things? Some words may go in more than one category.

- 1 people 2 objects 3 companies

» For more exercises, go to Practice file 13 on page 126.

5 Work with a partner. Describe and analyse the possible problems in these pictures. Use as many words from 2 and 3 as possible.



6 Work in small groups. Discuss the problems you might have with the following.

- two teams from different countries working together
- a very old office building
- a traditional office hierarchy
- buying electrical or electronic products abroad
- buying a second-hand computer
- buying things online

Example: If you buy a product abroad and it is faulty, it is very difficult to get it fixed or replaced.